

UPPER SUNCOAST SPORTS

Aces At Pine Crest Draw Controversy

By CHUCK ALBURY
(Times Bureau)

CLEARWATER — When is a hole-in-one not a hole-in-one? Answer to this riddle is apparently "when it's scored at the new Pine Crest Country Club in Largo." Anyway, the club has been informed by Golf Digest magazine's clearing house for aces that they can't be accepted since Pine Crest falls into the category of a par three course. The layout actually carries a par of 58 but that's neither here nor there.

A glance at the Pine Crest scorecard shows the course's shortest hole measures 110 yards. They climb up to 240 yards, a pretty solid whack in anybody's golf league.

Yet if someone knocks one in the cup from that distance, it still won't get recognition in official channels, though an ace at one of the other area golf clubs will, even though it's authored on a much shorter hole.

Seems that distance should have something to do with it. Obviously, it's just like holing a chip shot when you come up with a hole-in-one on some of the other par three course holes around, where many measure around 60 yards. But Pine Crest seems well above that level in all respects.

Anyway, the Pine Crest management is going to see that its hole-in-one shooters get suitable recognition, even if it's only on a local level. A plaque will be placed in the clubhouse where names of members scoring aces can be engraved. The honored players will also receive certificates attesting to their feat. Sounds like a nice idea.

More Bowling

Upper Pinellas' growing army of keggers will have still another

bowling establishment ready for pin-topping next winter. Dunedin Lanes is slated for construction on Patricia Ave., which is the northern extension of N. Highland Ave. out of Clearwater.

H. M. Hamilton and Dale Kallstrom are the managers of the project and hope to open the all-Brunswick house in August. It will be Dunedin's first bowling alleys but the fourth new ten pin center for Upper Pinellas, following constructions in Largo, Clearwater and Tarpon Springs.

Bomber Finances

If the Clearwater Bombers make it all the way to the 1960 Men's World Softball Tournament at Jones Beach, N.Y., next September, it will cost about \$8,000 more to carry the team through this time than in previous years. The extra money will be needed to get the team through additional tournament competition.

Since it has no automatic spot in the World Tourney field — as defending champ or host team — Clearwater must battle through the double eliminations and win a spot this time. Hosting the State Tourney in mid-August will save some money, but 1960 looms as a costly season for Manager Hank McWhorter's crew which began practice Monday night at Clearwater Athletic Field.

Glove Changes

Appearance at the Philadelphia Phila spring camp in Clearwater of baseball equipment salesmen brought on stories about the changes in gloves down through the years. Seems that today's big leather trap would make two or three of the ones Ty Cobb used for play.

"A lot of fielders used to cut the palm out, anyway," remembers Hall-of-Famer Paul Waner. "Then some used a piece of steak to pad their palm."

"Eddie Miller used a palmless glove and he was one of the best glove men around," recalled Phila Coach Ken Silvestri.

"Now they put a trap on like a hockey goal net," chimed in Coach Andy Cohen.

"Hank Greenberg came up with the first big trap for first basemen," offered Phila General Manager John Quinn. "They finally cut it down some and made it legal."

Some vets recalled the first Greenberg trap as "reaching the dirt when his hand was on his knee."

Former player John Moyer, now a glove salesman, remembers Stan Musial's reaction when he saw the modern gloves with near-fool proof pockets and traps. "They finally come out with something to help a guy like me when it's too late," Musial is said to have exclaimed.

Gulf High Club Appears Strong

(Times Bureau)

NEW PORT RICHEY — Gulf High School has no home diamond this spring but should field another strong baseball team. Playing its first season in the Tampa Bay Conference, the Buccaneers open up next Wednesday at Dunedin.

Baseball Coach Jim Pannell has been working out on the Little League field near Richey Elementary School. The regular Gulf diamond is getting a face-lifting, along with the football field, and won't be available this spring.

Pitchers for Gulf are vet Herman Spinks, a senior, along with sophomores Bill Colbert and Tom Kolean. The staff will also include Ken Densmore, Bill Oxendine, John Haney and Charles Gibson.

Senior Jim Frederick returns as catcher while another senior, Billy Denegar, is back in the outfield. Other outfielders are Bob Livermore, Ron Butler and Phil Chestnut.

Robert Bennett and Tommy Gibbs are battling for first base. Dan Sibley is at second while Larry Piper and Donnie Webb are third base candidates. Shortstops on the team are Bim Semago, Paul Lepisio and Pete Dumphy.

The schedule:

March 14 — at Dunedin; 18 — at Turkey Creek; 22 — at East Bay; 25 — at Pinecrest; 29 — at Dunedin.
April 1 — at Tarpon Springs; 5 — at St. Leo; 8 — at Bradenton; 12 — at St. Leo; 14 — at Brewster Tech; 22 — at Palmetto.

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